

Pre-Settlement to Moving Day Checklist — Victoria

The 30-90 day logistics, so nothing falls through the cracks.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal or financial advice.

Section 1 — Immediately After Signing (Exchange of Contracts)

- ☐ [] **Arrange building insurance from the moment you exchange contracts** — depending on your contract terms, risk can pass to you earlier than settlement day in Victoria. Confirm the exact timing with your conveyancer and don't leave this until settlement week.
- ☐ [] **Confirm your loan is progressing** — send your signed contract to your lender/broker immediately so formal loan documents can be prepared.
- ☐ [] **Diarise your cooling-off deadline** if it applies (3 clear business days for private sales) so you don't accidentally lose the right to withdraw without realising the window has closed.
- ☐ [] **Engage your conveyancer formally** (if not already done) so they can begin title searches, rates adjustments, and liaison with the vendor's side.

Section 2 — 4-6 Weeks Before Settlement

- ☐ [] **Finalise unconditional loan approval** and satisfy any outstanding lender conditions — don't leave this to the final week.
- ☐ [] **Start comparing removalist quotes** — get at least 3 quotes, and check reviews/insurance coverage; good removalists book out weeks in advance, especially over summer and around end-of-month periods.
- ☐ [] **Book your removalist** once you're confident on the settlement date.
- ☐ [] **Begin decluttering and sourcing packing materials** — this is also a good time to start using up perishable food and non-essential items you won't need before the move.
- ☐ [] **Notify your current landlord/agent (if renting)** of your intended move-out date, respecting your lease's required notice period.

Section 3 — 1-2 Weeks Before Settlement

- ☐ [] **Organise utility connections for the new property** — electricity, gas, water, internet/NBN (NBN connections can take longer than other utilities, so prioritise this one).
- ☐ [] **Arrange disconnection of utilities at your current address** for the day after you vacate.
- ☐ [] **Redirect your mail** via Australia Post's mail redirection service (available for up to 12 months).
- ☐ [] **Update your address** with: the electoral roll, your bank(s), your employer, Medicare, your insurer(s), and VicRoads (driver's licence and vehicle registration).
- ☐ [] **Confirm final loan settlement figures** with your lender/conveyancer, including any adjustments for rates, water, and owners corporation fees.
- ☐ [] **Confirm the FHOG paperwork responsibility** if claiming the grant — most lenders/conveyancers lodge this as part of settlement, but confirm who's handling it so it isn't missed (you can also apply directly to the SRO within 12 months of settlement if nobody lodges it for you).

Section 4 — Settlement Week

- ☐ [] **Book your pre-settlement inspection** in the days before settlement — this confirms the property is in the condition agreed in the contract and that included items (chattels/fittings) are still present.
- ☐ [] **Confirm final funds transfer arrangements** with your conveyancer and lender — know exactly when and how deposit/loan funds move on settlement day.
- ☐ [] **Confirm key collection arrangements** — where and when you'll receive keys, and from whom (usually the agent, once settlement is confirmed as complete).
- ☐ [] **Have your removalist confirmed for the day after settlement** (or settlement day itself if timing allows) — don't schedule movers before settlement is legally confirmed complete.

Section 5 — Moving Day and Just After

- ☐ [] **Do a final walkthrough** before unpacking, checking for any damage that wasn't present at your pre-settlement inspection — photograph everything as a record.
- ☐ [] **Locate your fuse box, water mains shut-off, and gas shut-off** early — useful in an emergency and often overlooked in the moving-day rush.
- ☐ [] **Set up home and contents insurance** if not already arranged (don't rely on the vendor's building insurance, which typically ends at settlement).
- ☐ [] **Register any relevant council services** (bin collection, etc.) if not automatically transferred.
- ☐ [] **Keep all settlement paperwork** (contract, Section 32, loan documents, FHOG confirmation) in one place — you'll need these for tax, insurance, and future reference.

Quick Reference — Settlement Week Timeline

TIMING	KEY TASK
Exchange of contracts	Building insurance starts, engage conveyancer
4-6 weeks out	Loan approval finalised, book removalist
1-2 weeks out	Utilities connected, mail redirected, address updates

Settlement week	Pre-settlement inspection, confirm funds transfer
Settlement day	Keys released, final walkthrough

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